



Recovery of Kashmir Markhor *Capra falconeri* –

A threatened mountain ungulate in Jammu and Kashmir, Union Territory of India



Photo by: Shabir Bhat

Impact Report
(2022-26)

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Acknowledgements

LOCAL STAKEHOLDERS	Local communities in and around the Kazinag and Pir Panjal ranges
GOVERNMENT BODIES	Department of Wildlife Protection, Jammu and Kashmir Department of Tourism, Kashmir District Administrations Judicial Academy, Srinagar, J&K Indian Army Jammu and Kashmir Police
RESEARCH INSTITUTIONS	University of Kashmir, Srinagar Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Science and Technology, Kashmir (SKUAST-K) Bhartiya Vidyapeeth University, Pune
EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS	Higher and Senior Secondary Schools, Hirpora, Shopian, J&K Higher and Senior Secondary Schools, Bijhama, Baramulla, J&K
DONORS	Astral Foundation Thin Greenline Foundation, UK



Photo by: Tanveer Ahmad War

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Photo by: Tanveer Ahmad War

Executive Summary

Markhor *Capra falconeri*, the world's largest wild goat, is native to Central Asia. The flare-horned subspecies, *Capra falconeri*, known as the Pir Panjal or Kashmir markhor, occurs only in the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir in India. Because they occur near international borders, Markhor habitats are prone to livestock grazing and developmental activities, including roads, mining, high-tension power lines, and border fencing. Overall, there is consensus that their populations are declining and that sustained conservation efforts are needed to ensure their continued survival within their only distribution range in the Indian subcontinent.

The Markhor Recovery project, being implemented by the Wildlife Trust of India (WTI) since 2005, has been working in close collaboration with the Department of Wildlife Protection (DWP), Jammu and Kashmir (J&K) to ensure the long-term survival of the Kashmir Markhor (listed in Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, and 'Near Threatened'

under the IUCN Red List of Threatened Species (IUCN Red List 2014).

Overall in the last four years, WTI in partnership with the DWP, J&K and financial support from the Astral Foundation, carried out project activities specifically aiming at monitoring the Markhor population growth and recruitment rates in the Protected Areas (PAs), securing the Critical Markhor Habitats (CMHs) in the PAs, especially in the Pir Panjal range by reducing livestock grazing pressure, enhanced patrolling by trained and equipped frontline staff and local community members in the Kazinag and the Pir Panjal range, strengthening the capacity of law enforcement agencies, and reducing the dependency on forest resources and increasing support to the local communities in the Kazinag range by promoting alternative livelihood options in the fringe villages of the Kazinag National Park. In addition, we aimed to enhance the visibility and awareness of Markhor conservation efforts in J&K.

Over the past four years, Markhor conservation efforts in J&K by the Wildlife Trust of India (WTI) and the Department of Wildlife Protection (DWP), J&K, with support from the Astral Foundation, have achieved Markhor population growth estimated using scientifically robust monitoring methods, Critical Markhor Habitats (CMHs) protection in the PAs, strengthened capacity of the DWP frontline staff and enforcement agencies, and empowered local communities as custodians and key stakeholders in Markhor Conservation.

Key Achievements

An increase in Markhor population in the Kazinag range from 221 ± 12.5 individuals in 2023 to 227 ± 13.9 individuals in 2026.

A recruitment rate of 69.0% in the Kazinag Markhor population, indicating strong reproductive success and juvenile survival.

2000+ km surveyed in Kazinag and 1400+ km surveyed in the Pir Panjal range.

8% reduction in livestock population grazing in the Hirpora Wildlife Sanctuary (WLS).

140+ DWP frontline staff trained and equipped for effective patrolling and wildlife monitoring.

A network of 44 Markhor Watchers established to strengthen community engagement in conservation initiatives.

Reduction in non-bonafide/illegal livestock grazing in the Hirpora WLS by 26% in 2025.

Ecotourism initiatives around the Kazinag National Park – A setup involving 6 Homestays and 22 nature guides established around the Kazinag National Park.

Public outreach involving 4000+ people, alongside international and national recognition of these conservation models by presenting the project and its impacts in over seven forums.

Way Forward

Building on the progress achieved so far, continued collaboration between the Wildlife Trust of India and the Department of Wildlife Protection, Jammu & Kashmir will remain essential for securing the long-term future of the Markhor in Jammu and Kashmir. Future efforts should focus on strengthening protection and monitoring in key habitats, particularly within Kazinag National Park and Hirpora Wildlife Sanctuary, while further reducing grazing pressure and mitigating emerging threats from infrastructure and human disturbance. Using advanced population monitoring methods, including thermal drones, camera traps, and radio-collars, would improve data quality and enable more informed conservation planning and implementation. Expanding community-based initiatives such as the Markhor Watcher network, promoting sustainable livelihood options through ecotourism, and enhancing scientific monitoring of populations and habitats will be critical. These integrated actions will help consolidate the gains made under the Markhor Recovery Project and ensure the sustained conservation of this flagship species across the landscape.



Photo by: Intesar Suhail

Summary of Key Achievements (2022-2026)

1. Estimation of Markhor population in the PAs of Kazinag range:

- **Estimated Markhor population in the Kazinag National Park (NP)**, including the Limber and Lachipora WLSs, and the Naganari Conservation Reserve (CR) using a scientifically robust double-observer survey method. **The 2026 estimate of 227 ± 13.9 individuals showed a slight increase from 221 ± 12.5 individuals in 2023.**
- Surveys showed a **healthy and slowly growing Markhor population in Kazinag**, with a high recruitment rate of **69 kids per 100 adult females**, suggesting successful breeding and juvenile survival.
- **Recorded 600 direct sightings of Markhor in 2026**: 131 in summer, 158 in autumn, 127 in winter, and 184 in spring across four seasons in the Kazinag range through repeated monitoring of 12 permanent trails.
- **Piloted the first-ever thermal drone survey** in the Hirpora WLS with due permission from the Department of Wildlife Protection, J&K, the Indian Army, and Air Traffic Control (ATC), Srinagar, J&K.

2. Secured Critical Markhor Habitats (CMHs) in Protected Areas (PAs):

- **Critical Markhor Habitats (CMHs) identified in Kazinag NP and Hirpora WLS.** Habitat suitability analysis showed that **50% of Kazinag NP is highly suitable for Markhor in summer and 18% in winter**, while Hirpora WLS has comparatively limited suitable habitat (14% in summer and 11% in winter).
- **Established anti-grazing camps at strategic entry points in the Hirpora WLS with the DWP, J&K.**
- **26% reduction in non-bonafide/illegal livestock herding in Hirpora WLS in 2025.**

- **Over 185 transient herders were stopped** from entering the sanctuary without valid permits.
- **8% reduction in livestock numbers visiting Hirpora WLS between 2023 and 2025.**

3. Capacity building and equipping of DWP frontline staff, law enforcement agencies, and local communities to deal with wildlife crime and illegal wildlife trade:

- **Trained and equipped 140+ DWP frontline staff** to conduct wildlife monitoring using scientifically robust field techniques and methods.
- **Strengthened wildlife law enforcement through training of more than 100 DWP frontline staff, 47 judicial officers from J&K and Ladakh, and 18 wildlife officials and local lawyers** on wildlife protection laws and wildlife crime prevention.
- **Trained and equipped 44 Markhor watchers** in North, South, and Shopian Divisions to conduct systematic livestock monitoring, detect illegal grazing, and report poaching activities.
- **Efforts led to wildlife rescues, poacher apprehension, removal of traps, and monitoring of migratory herders** across key Markhor habitats for effective patrolling and wildlife monitoring.
- **Provided field gear** (winter jackets, field bag, raincoat, torch, walking stick, water bottle, and cap) **to 50 DWP frontline staff in 2024.**

- Provided two motorbikes to the DWP, North Division for human-wildlife conflict mitigation in 2024.
- Provided field gear (sleeping bags, torch, and camera traps) to DWP, North Division for human-wildlife conflict mitigation in 2023.
- Provided winter jackets to 45 DWP frontline staff, Central Division, in 2022.

4. Reduced the dependency of local communities on Markhor habitats:

- Promoted alternative livelihood opportunities in villages around Kazinag National Park to reduce dependency on forest resources.
- Established a setup for ecotourism around the Kazinag NP with the establishment of 6 homestays and 22 nature guides.
- Trained the homestay owners and nature guides in hospitality, tourist management, and responsible tourism practices, and first-aid and CPR training.
- Established a tailoring training center in Babagail village in March 2025, where 22 women from local self-help groups were trained, collectively earning ₹72,000 between July–December 2025.
- Strengthened community participation in conservation through Markhor watcher networks and livelihood support, with over 70% of local communities expressing positive support for Markhor and wildlife conservation in the Kazinag range.
- 32 households generated an annual income of approximately INR 1,17,000 in the year 2025-26.

5. Awareness and outreach programs highlighting Markhor conservation in J&K:

- Over 4,000 participants joined a UT-level Wildlife Walkathon in 2023, organized with the Department of Wildlife Protection, J&K, during Wildlife Week to promote public awareness and environmental responsibility.

- More than 250 school students participated in Wildlife Week celebrations, nature walk, and painting competitions in and around the Markhor habitats.
- Celebrated the first International Day of the Markhor (May 24, 2025) at Kazinag, involving 45 students, and participated in the World Species Congress 2024 at Hirpora with 40 school students.
- Represented the Markhor conservation work in national and international forums, including the Indian Conference on Conservation (ICCON, 2024), the Indian Wildlife Ecology Conference (IWEC), the 8th and 9th World Congress on Mountain Ungulates (WCMU) in October 2024 in Italy and Tajikistan.

1 Background

The Markhor (*Capra falconeri*) – the world's largest goat – is an iconic, Near Threatened mountain ungulate with ecological and cultural significance in the Kashmir Himalaya. In India, it occurs only in the Union Territory (UT) of Jammu and Kashmir (J&K). Like other ungulates in mountainous ecosystems, the species has been affected from livestock grazing, poaching, habitat fragmentation, and developmental pressures such as road construction and linear intrusions. Exposure to these anthropogenic pressures over an extended period has made them highly vulnerable to local extinction in parts of their distribution range in the UT. Of the two viable populations in J&K, the population in the Kazinag range has gradually recovered over the past two decades, while the same is not true for the population in Pir Panjal range, especially in the Hirpora Wildlife Sanctuary (WLS).

Following range-wide population assessment in J&K in 2004-05 (Bhatnagar et al., 2009), the Wildlife

Trust of India has been consistently supporting conservation efforts through Markhor Recovery Project in collaboration with the Department of Wildlife Protection (DWP), J&K, with support from multiple funding partners.

Through the project, continued efforts have been made to improve the status of the species. The project monitored the Markhor population and its habitats; ensured reduced anthropogenic pressure on Critical Markhor Habitats (CMHs) in PAs; built the capacity of frontline staff and local youth to enhance protection and vigilance in Markhor habitats; identified suitable Markhor habitats outside PAs; and reduced local communities' dependence on Markhor habitats.

The report compiles the efforts and achievements towards Markhor conservation in the state over the last four years, largely supported by funding from the Astral Foundation.



Photo by: Tanveer Ahmad War



Photo by: Sreenanth K

1.1 WTI and DWP Partnership Towards Markhor Recovery in J&K

Over the past two decades, the Wildlife Trust of India, in close collaboration with the Department of Wildlife Protection, Jammu & Kashmir, has been actively involved in the recovery and conservation of the Markhor in the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir along with the local communities living in and around the Markhor habitats, both within and outside the PAs.

The collaboration began in 2004-05 with the first status survey (Bhatnagar et al. 2009), which mapped and monitored Markhor distribution across the region. Based on these early surveys, several conservation measures were undertaken, including the notification of Kazinag National Park in 2007 through the consolidation of Limber Wildlife Sanctuary, Lachipora Wildlife Sanctuary and Naganari Conservation Reserve. Additionally, around 150 km² was added to Hirpora Wildlife Sanctuary in 2007, and later, in 2012, Tatakutti Wildlife Sanctuary (66 km²) was notified following WTI's documentation of Markhor in the area.

Joint efforts have contributed to reduced non-traditional livestock grazing in Hirpora WLS, leading to a decrease of nearly 3,000 livestock in recent years (2018-2025). Capacity development of frontline staff to improve wildlife monitoring, enforcement, and response to wildlife crime was another area in which WTI and DWP, J&K, worked together.

Community participation has been a key component of the initiative. Local youth have been organized into monitoring and vigilance teams known as 'Markhor Watchers', who assist in field surveys, track wildlife movements, and report illegal activities. Additionally, efforts have aimed to reduce fringe villages' dependence on forests by linking communities with government livelihood schemes and promoting ecotourism. With the support of the Department of Tourism, Jammu and Kashmir, an ecotourism society has been formed, with homestays and trained nature guides from fringe villages registered to promote sustainable livelihood opportunities.

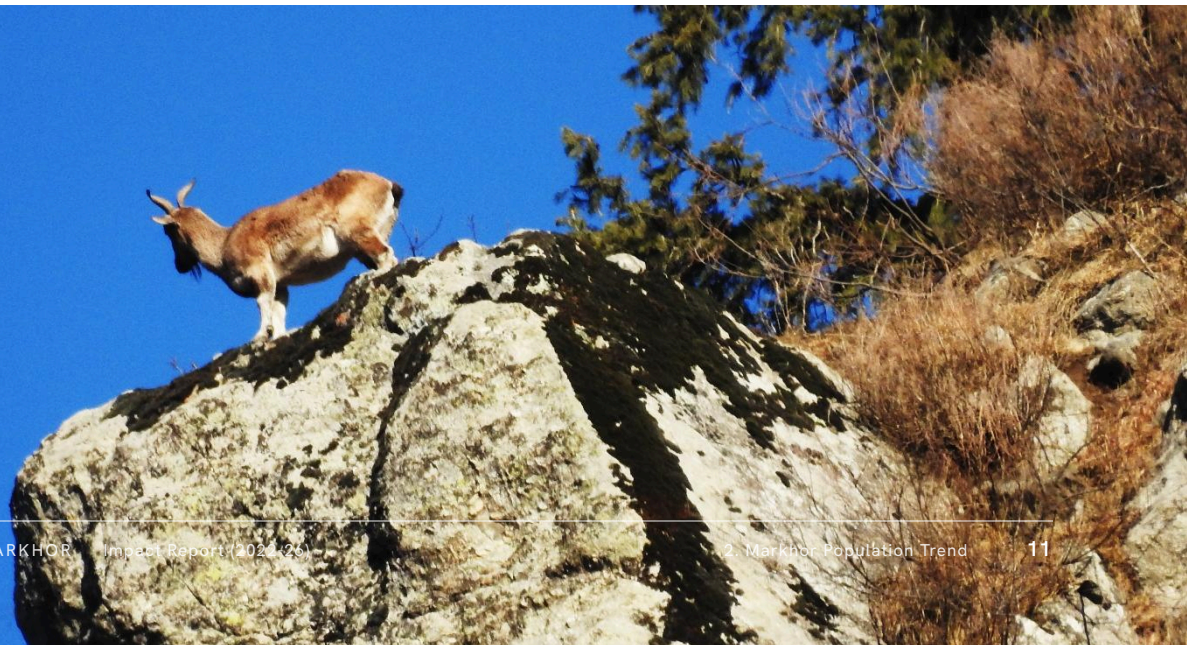
2

Markhor Population Trend in the Kazinag Range

MARKHOR POPULATION ESTIMATES

We estimated the Markhor population in the Kazinag National Park, including Limber and Lachipora WLSs using a scientifically robust double-observer method in 2023 and 2026. We systematically walked 2000+ km in the park over the last four years. **The population estimates generated in 2026 and 2023 were 227 ± 13.9 individuals and 221 ± 12.5 individuals, respectively.** Also, the population recruitment rates suggest a healthy growing population in the Kazinag range with high female to male and female to kid ratio.

- **Covered a distance of 2000+ km in the Kazinag range** – During the past four years, we have walked more than 2000 km on 12 permanently marked trails in the Kazinag range to monitor the Markhor population in the Kazinag National Park, including the Limber and Lachipora WLSs and the Naganari Conservation Reserve.
- **Population estimates show a stable trend** – The 2026 population estimate of 227 ± 13.9 (95% CI: 213.1–240.9) indicates a broadly stable population compared with 2023 estimate of 221 ± 12.5 individuals and previous estimates. The estimated number of Markhor groups present in the area was 48, with a mean group size of 5.11 ± 0.62 (range 1-18). The population trend in the last two decades show a slow and steady growth from 133 individuals recorded in 2005 till 227 individuals in 2026 (Figure 2).
- **Assessed population growth** – We recorded a male-to-female ratio of 33 males per 100 females and a high kid-to-adult female ratio of **69 kids per 100 adult females**, indicating strong recruitment and suggesting a healthy and potentially increasing population.



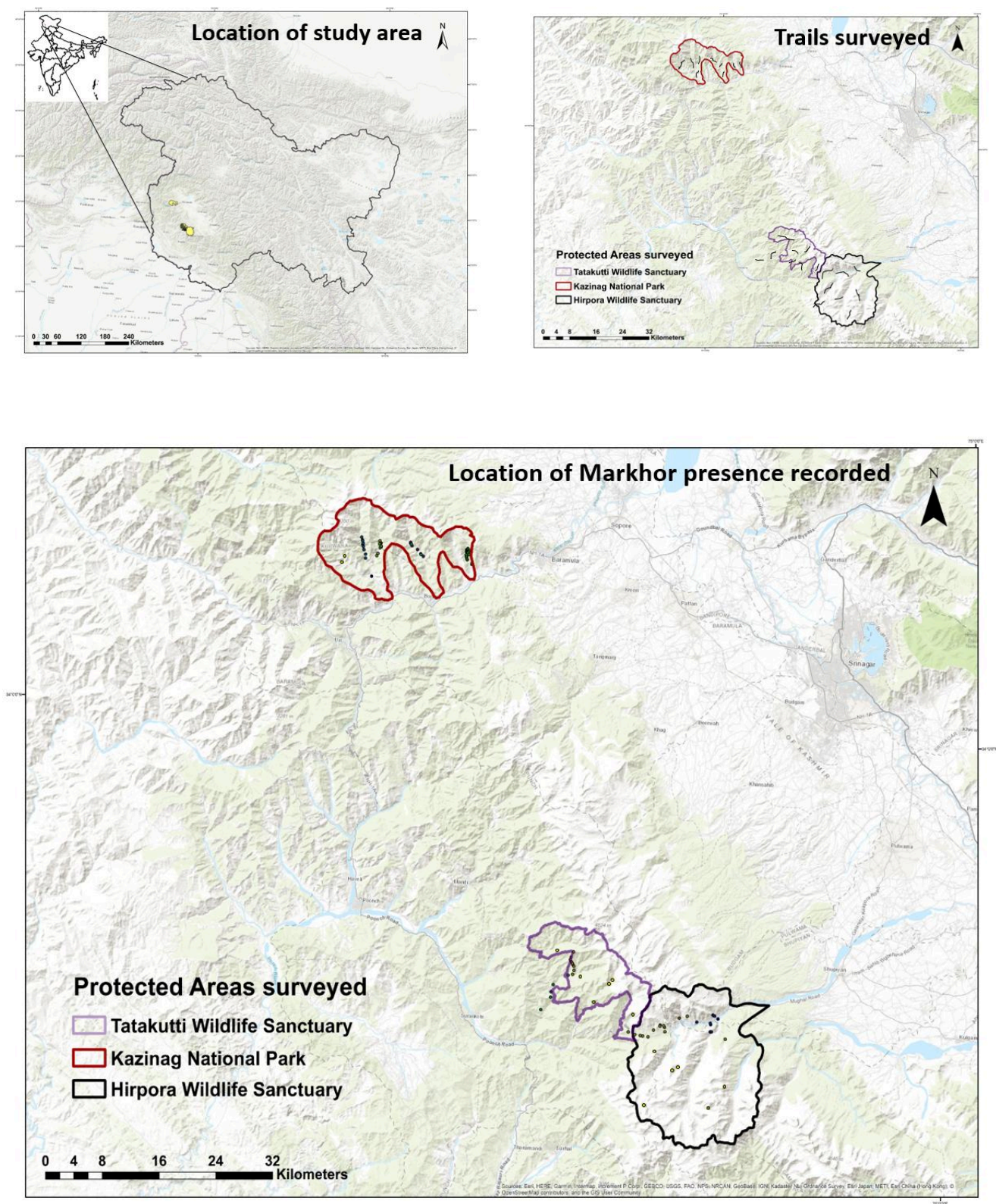


Figure 1: Location of the project area and the sampling trails in the Protected Areas.

Markhor population estimate

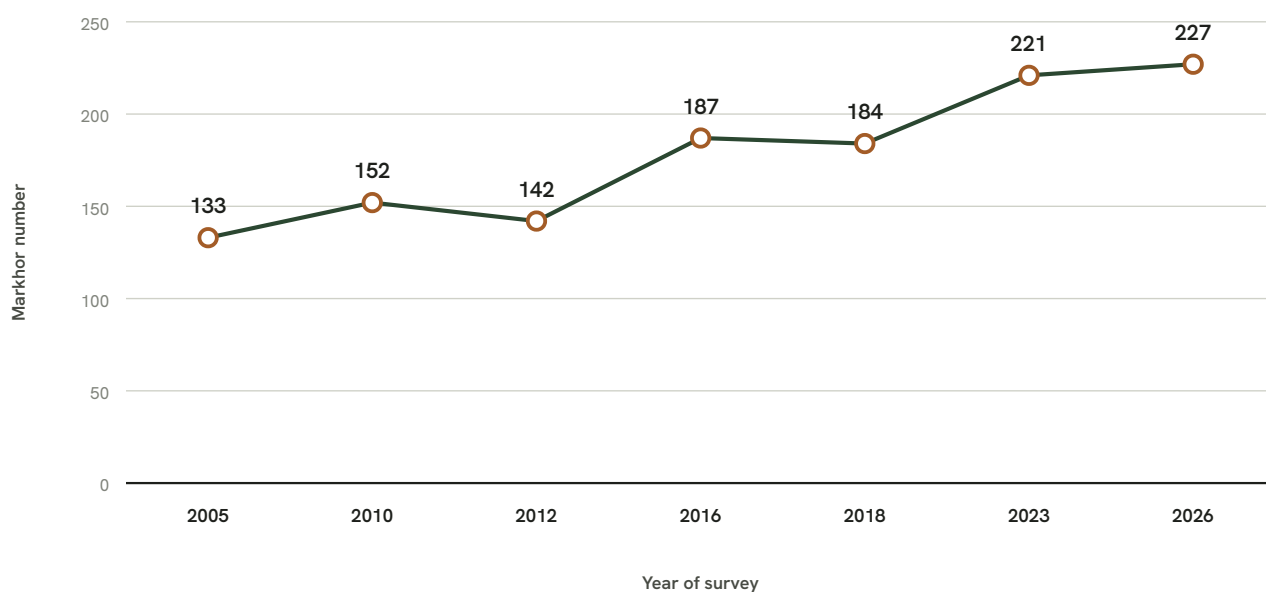


Figure 2: Trend in Markhor population between 2005 and 2026 in the Kazinag range, J&K.

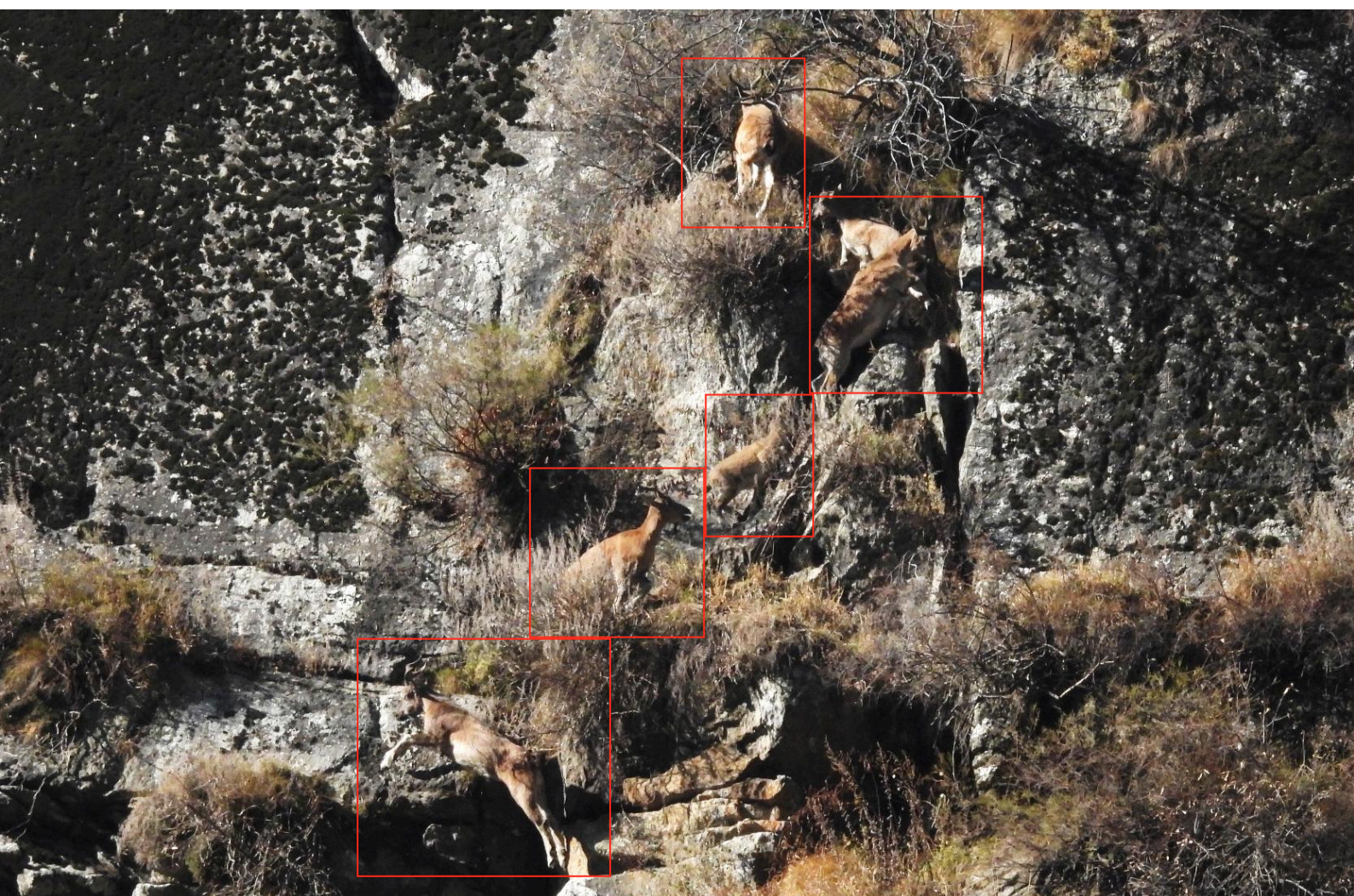


Photo by: Tanveer Ahmad War



Photo by: Tanveer Ahmad War

Table 1: Comparison of markhor numbers between the 2004-05 survey by Bhatnagar et al. 2009 and subsequent surveys by WTI and DWP till 2026.

Year of survey	KAZINAG NP				HIRPORA WLS			
	Total count	Adult male (%)	Adult female (%)	Kid (%)	Total count	Adult male (%)	Adult female (%)	Kid (%)
2005	133	-	-	-	80	-	-	-
2010	152	25	47	26	30-35	10	65	25
2012	142	26	47	23	20-25	10	70	20
2016	187	21	38	20	15-20	10	80	10
2018	184	27	41	16	Low sightings	-	-	-
2023	221	27	55	-	Low sightings	-	-	-
2026	227	10	44	30	NA	-	-	-



Glimpses of Markhor surveys and distribution of certificates to the participants for assisting in the census (2022-2026).

Photo by: Tanveer Ahmad War & Junaid Bin Hussain

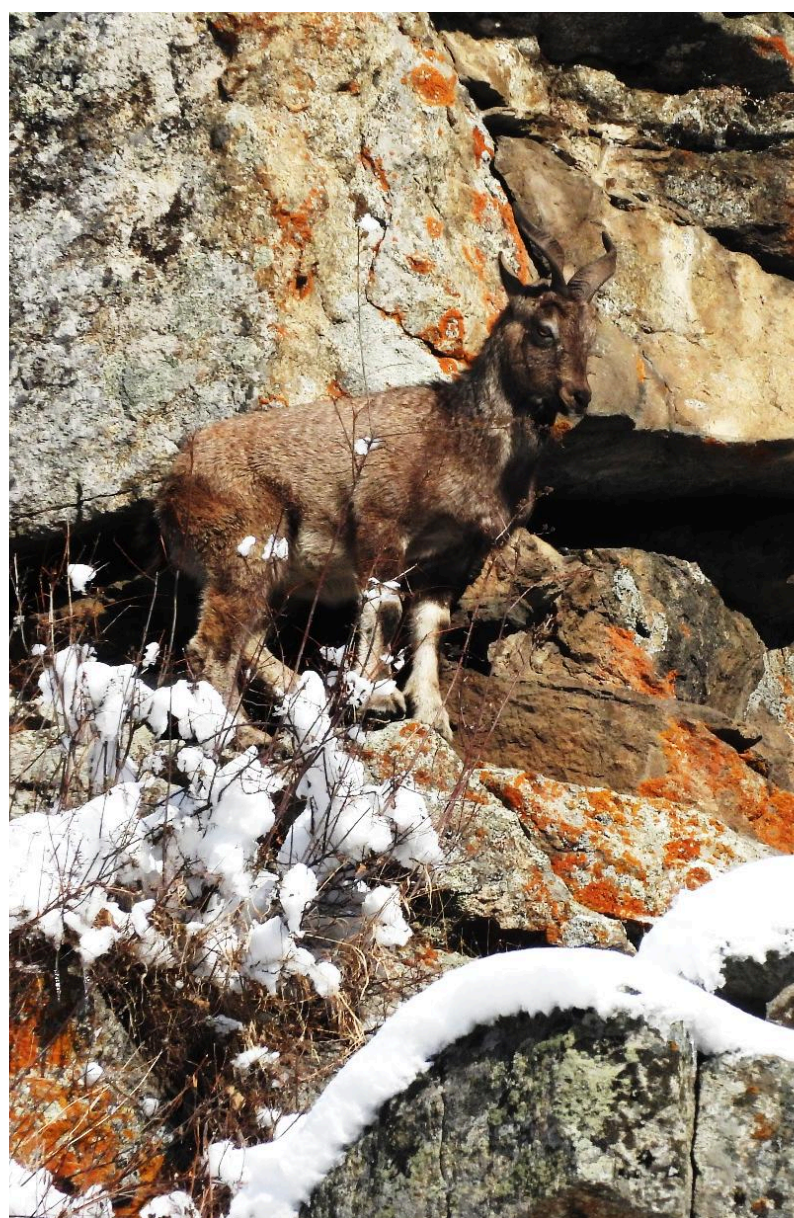


Photo by: Tanveer Ahmad War

3

Secured Critical Markhor Habitats (CMHs) in Protected Areas

REDUCING LIVESTOCK GRAZING PRESSURE IN CMHS BETWEEN 2022 AND 2026:

In the last four years (2022-26), the livestock grazing pressure in the Hirpora WLS has reduced by 8%; the non-bonafide herding practices have reduced by 26%; more than 185 transient herders have been deterred from unauthorised camping in and around the sanctuary.

- **Identified CMHs in Kazinag NP and Hirpora WLS using a robust framework** – According to habitat suitability analysis, 50% and 18% of the total area in the Kazinag range are highly suitable and critical for markhor presence during the summer and winter seasons, respectively. In Hirpora WLS, only 14% and 11% of the area were highly suitable and critical for markhor presence during the summer and winter seasons, respectively.
- **Established anti-poaching and grazing checkpoints** – DWP and WTI established and supported grazing check posts at strategic locations in Hirpora WLS and verified herders' documents en route to their grazing pastures.
- **185 transient herders were deterred from unauthorised entry in the Hirpora WLS** – Establishment of anti-grazing camps by DWP and WTI, and strict surveillance at strategic entry points prevented transient livestock herders from illegally entering and camping in Hirpora WLS.
- **8% reduction in livestock numbers and 26% reduction in non-bonafide herders in Hirpora WLS between 2021 and 2025** – The three-year surveys indicated an 8% decline in livestock numbers, i.e., from a baseline of 9,626 (average of 2022, 23, & 24) to 8,866 in 2025. The surveys also indicated that non-bonafide herding decreased by 26.38% in 2025 compared with the baseline (the average of the past three years, 2022-2024).

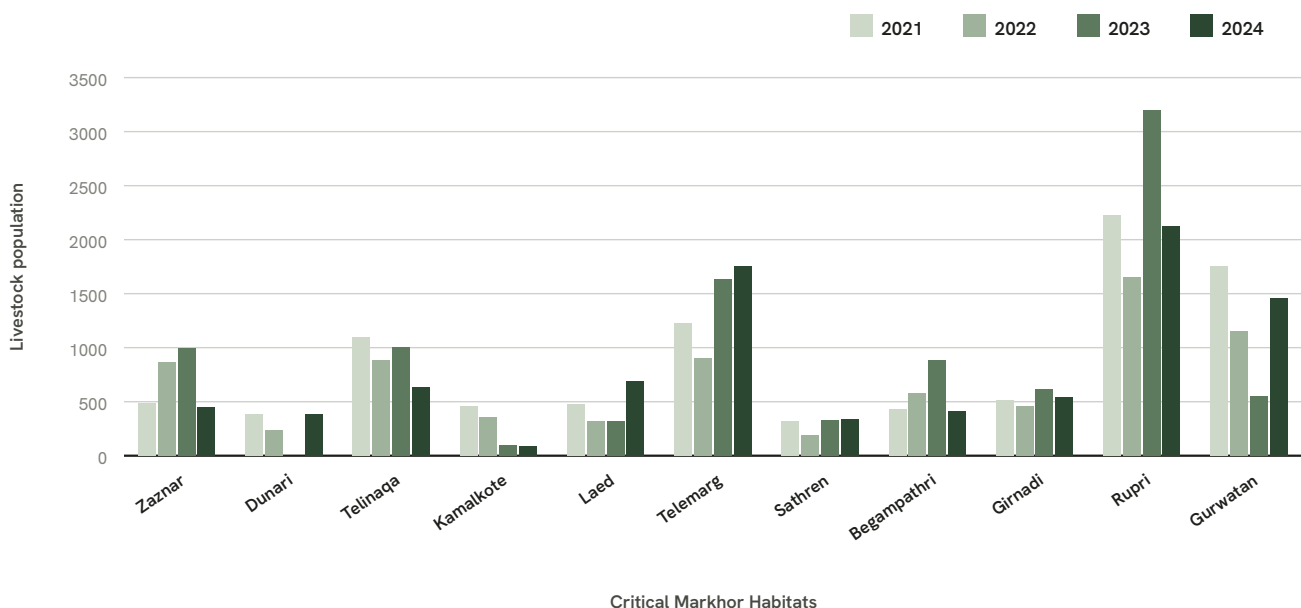


Figure 3: Reduction in livestock numbers visiting the CMHs in the Hirpora WLS between 2021 to 2024.

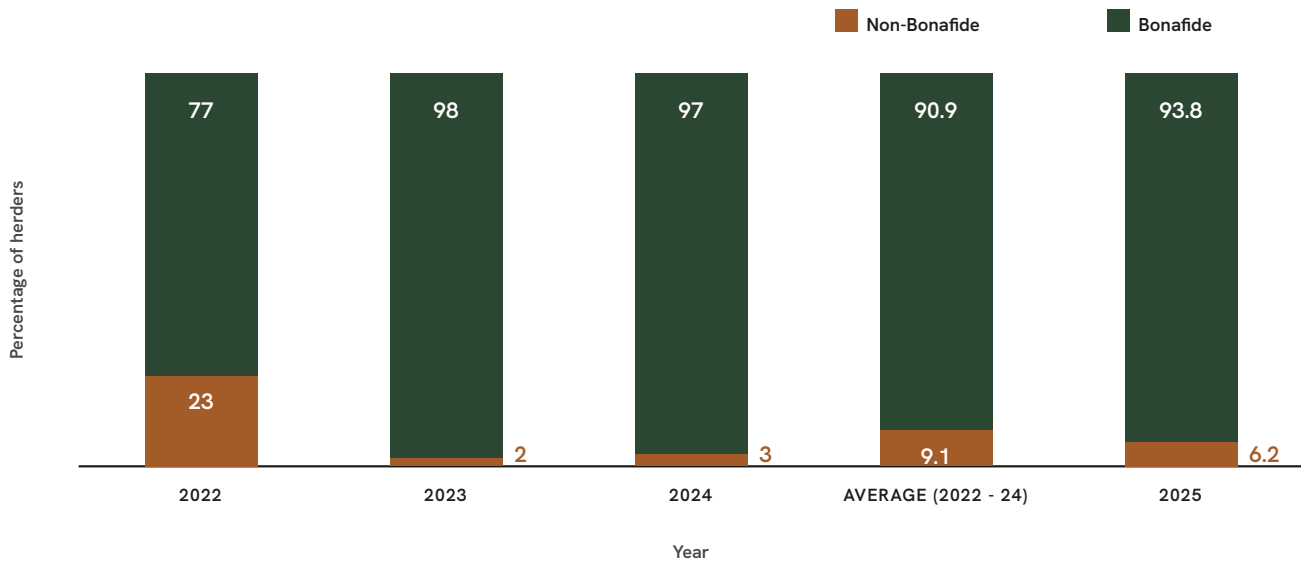


Figure 4: Reduction in non-bonafide herding in and around the Hirpora WLS between 2022 and 2025.



Grazing check posts at strategic locations in Hirpora WLS and DWP, with WTI staff verifying herders' documents en route to their grazing pastures.

Photo by: Junaid Bin Hussain

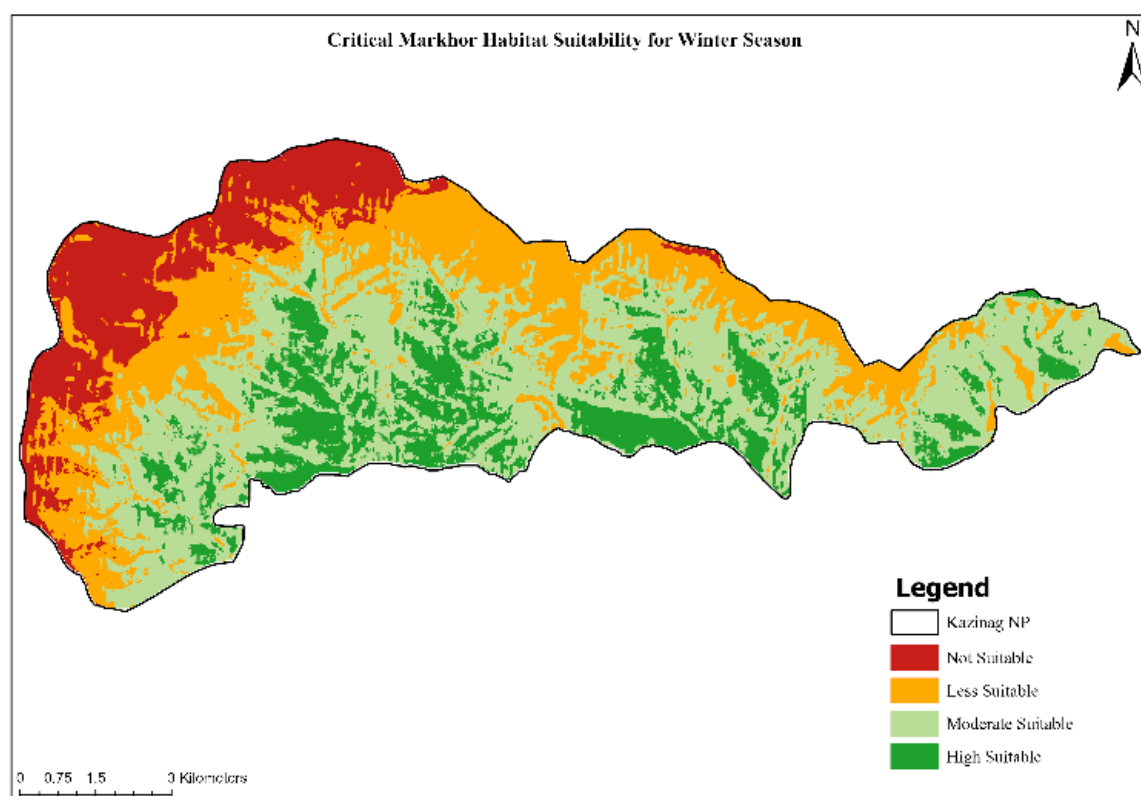
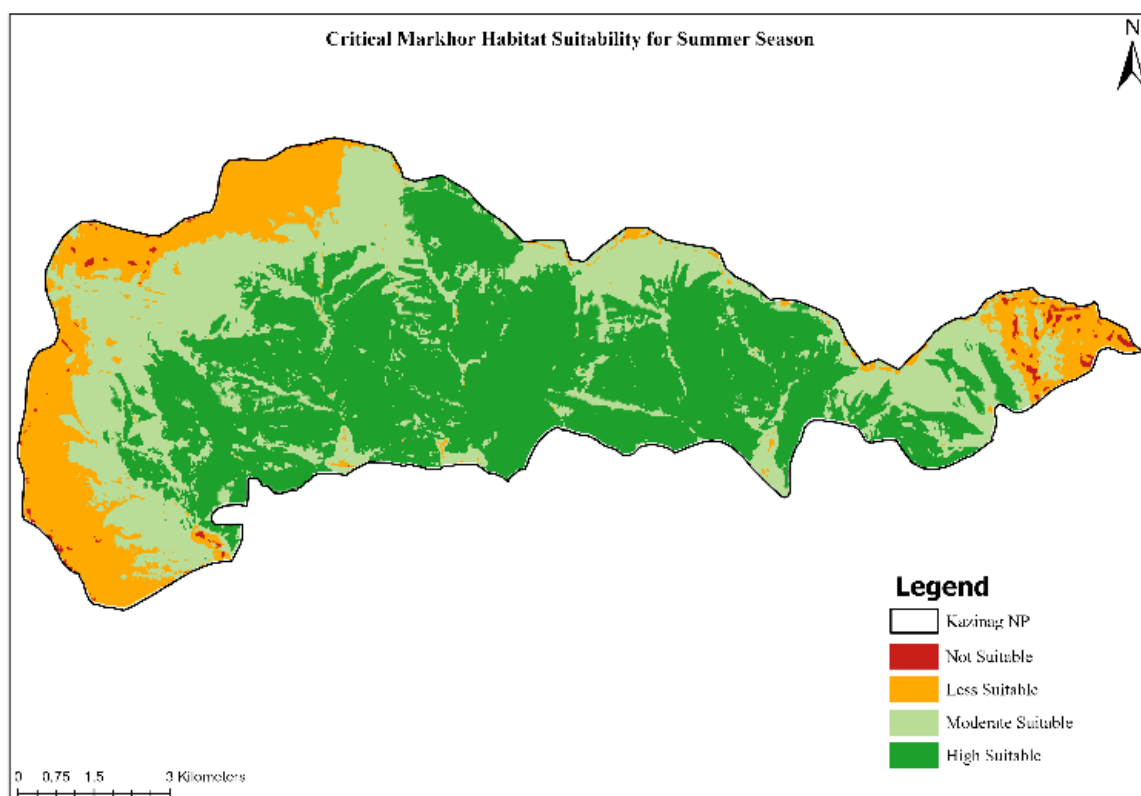


Figure 5: Critical Markhor Habitats (CMHs) in summer and winter identified in the Kazinag NP.

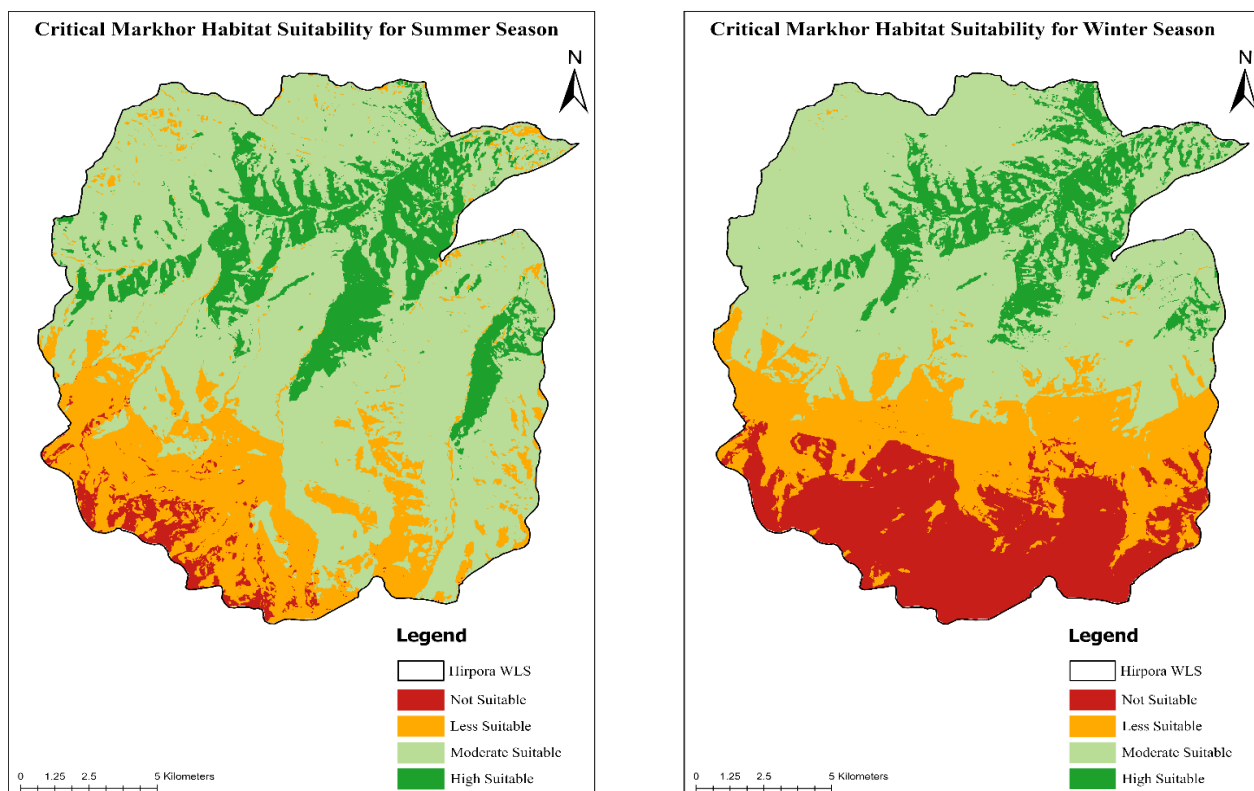


Figure 6: Critical Markhor Habitats (CMHs) in summer and winter identified in the Hirpora WLS.



Glimpses of livestock grazing in the Hirpora WLS.

Photo by: Tanushree Srivastava

4

Capacity Building of DWP Frontline Staff and Key Stakeholders

STRENGTHENED THE CAPACITY OF LAW ENFORCEMENT AGENCIES AND OTHER STAKEHOLDERS:

In the last four years (2022-26), WTI has trained and equipped 145 DWP frontline staff, 47 judicial officers of J&K and Ladakh, 18 senior wildlife officials & local lawyers, and 44 Markhor Watchers to efficiently deal with wildlife crime and illegal trade, besides field techniques in wildlife monitoring.

IN 2022-23 -

- Training on field techniques for wildlife population monitoring – Trained 90 DWP frontline staff and volunteers from local universities in field techniques in wildlife monitoring.

IN 2023-24 -

- **Two-day workshop on the 'Wildlife (Protection) Act 1972, Amendments 2022'** – Trained 69 Wildlife and Forest Protection Force (FPF) officers (4 Wildlife Wardens; 4 Range Officers; 3 Foresters; 3 Block Officers; 30 Guards; 3 Rehbar-e-janglat; 11 Helpers; 5 Asst. Directors (FPF); 3 Deputy Inspectors (FPF); 2 Forest Guards (FPF); 1 lawyer) in crime prevention in the light of latest amendments in the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.



Two-day workshop on the 'Wildlife (Protection) Act 1972, Amendments 2022'.

- **Three-day training on Wildlife Crime Prevention** – Trained and equipped 55 frontline staff in a three-day training on wildlife crime prevention (Field kits distributed to the participants – Annex I).



Photo by: Sreenanth K



Field gear distribution to the DWP frontline staff participating in the three-day Wildlife Crime Prevention training.

Photo by: Tanushree Srivastava

- **One-day legal workshop on Wildlife Protection Laws for Judicial Officers** – Trained 47 Judicial officers of J&K and Ladakh on wildlife crime and protection laws at the Judicial Academy, Srinagar.
- **One-day legal workshop on Wildlife Protection Laws for DWP officials and lawyers** – Trained 18 participants, including local lawyers, Wildlife wardens, and Range Officers (DWP) on wildlife protection laws.



Photo by: Tanveer Ahmad War

FROM 2022 TO 2026 - — Trained and equipped a group of 44 DWP casual laborers and Markhor watchers with field gear, including winter jackets, shoes, and field bags, from local communities for wildlife monitoring and wildlife crime prevention.



Tanushree

Limber | 11 December 2025 at 1:11 pm



Photo by: Junaib Bin Hussain



Wildlife conservation training bolsters Markhor, Hangul watchers in B'la

NOOR MOHI UD DIN

Baramulla, Dec 12: In a concerted effort to protect the Markhor and Hangul species in the Union Territory (UT) of Jammu and Kashmir, the Wildlife Trust of India (WTI), in collaboration with the Department of Wildlife Protection (DWP), on Tuesday undertook a comprehensive training program for local communities in north Kashmir's Baramulla.

The training aims to equip Markhor and Hangul watchers with the skills necessary for effective patrolling and monitoring during the winter season.

An official of Wildlife Trust of India said that anthropogenic activities, including road construction, power lines, army settle-



ments, livestock grazing, and poaching, have severely impacted the habitats and populations of Markhor (*Capra falconeri*) and Hangul (*Cervus hanglu*) in the region.

The one-day capacity-building program, conducted at the Range office in Baramulla, brought together 25 participants and focused on enhancing their ability to carry out vigilant patrolling during the winter when these mountain ungulates migrate to lower

elevations.

Dr. Tanushree Srivastava, Project Head and Manager at WTI, emphasized the critical role of Markhor and Hangul Watchers in monitoring animal movements, reporting illegal activities, and safeguarding these vulnerable species.

The training covered aspects such as identifying hoof marks, scats, pellets, and using indirect methods to detect the presence of wildlife during patrolling surveys.

Glimpses of DWP staff and Markhor watchers carrying out field patrolling and surveys.

Photo by: Junaid Bin Hussain & Tanveer Ahmad War

FROM 2022 TO 2026 - — Equipping of the DWP frontline staff through the Rapid Action Project (RAP) grant at WTI – Field gear including motorbikes, winter jackets, shoes, field bags, tents, and camera traps provided to the frontline staff of North, Central, South, Shopian, and Kishtwar Divisions of DWP, J&K (Details and sanction letters – Annex II, III, & I).



Motorbikes provided to frontline staff at North Division, DWP for conflict mitigation.

5

Reduced the Dependency of Local Communities on Markhor Habitats

REDUCED DEPENDENCY OF LOCAL COMMUNITIES IN FRINGE VILLAGES AROUND KAZINAG NATIONAL PARK:

The livelihood interventions introduced by WTI have enabled at least 32 households to earn a living from various sources. At the macroeconomic level, total revenue generated from the tailoring center and homestays (approximately Rs. 1,17,000 in the 2025 assessment period) may seem small, but in the context of rural fringe village economies, this value is significant.

This has also led more than 70% of local communities in the fringe villages in the Kazinag range to strongly support Markhor conservation in the area.

- **Trained and sensitized a group of 22 nature guides and six homestay owners** through a series of training and workshops on hospitality, management, and first aid in the last three years.
- **17 identified nature guides applied for registration as nature guides** at the Kashmir Tourism Department.
- **Homestays in Kazinag hosting tourists** – The six registered homestays are hosting tourists and earning revenue from the initiative.
- **10 Markhor watchers working as paid field guides with various research institutions** – Of the 20 Markhor watchers, ten are frequently involved and are paid for assisting the team and other researchers and research institutions during their fieldwork.
- **More than 70% of the local communities around Kazinag NP support Markhor conservation efforts** – A questionnaire survey suggested that the local communities in and around the Kazinag NP support Markhor as well as wildlife conservation in the Kazinag range. Most of the responses were positive and supportive (>70-80%).



Workshop on hospitality and tourist management for nature guides in Kazinag range.

Photo by: Tanushree Srivastava

- 22 women from the local communities, trained at the tailoring training center established at Kazinag – At the tailoring training center established in the Babagail village, 20 women have successfully received the training from three female trainers from within these villages in Kazinag. This group of 22 women began earning income through stitching and collectively earned 72,000 INR between July and December 2025, compared with 0 INR prior to this period.



Photo by: Tanushree Srivastava



One-day training on livelihood options from nature-based solutions: as wildlife cum ecotourism guides.

Photo by: Junaid Bin Hussain

6

Awareness and Outreach for Markhor Conservation

AWARENESS AND OUTREACH PROGRAMS:

The awareness among the local mass was enhanced by organizing various outreach and awareness programs, in which more than 4000+ people participated in a UT-level Wildlife Walkathon organized in wildlife week 2023; 200+ students participated in various awareness programs, and the work was represented in various national and international forums in the last four years.

- Over 4,000 people participated in the UT-level Wildlife Walkathon organized to celebrate Wildlife Week in 2023 – As part of the outreach program, a Wildlife Walkathon was organized on the 2nd of October 2023, i.e., Wildlife Week, by the Department of Wildlife Protection, J&K, in collaboration with WTI. The Hon'ble Lieutenant Governor of J&K flagged off the walkathon, which was a significant success, with over 4,000 participants, including stakeholders such as the J&K Police, students, scholars, and faculty members from local schools, colleges, and Universities, as well as representatives from local NGOs.
- 200+ school children participated in various wildlife awareness and outreach programs – Students from 10 government schools in the fringe villages of Kazinag and the Pir Panjal ranges participated in various events like nature walks, essay competitions, and painting competitions, organized on the occasions of Wildlife Week, International Day of the Markhor, and World Species Congress.
- Presented the Markhor work at national and international forums – including the International Conference on 'Wildlife Conservation: Emerging Scenario and Way Forward', Indian Conference on Conservation (ICCON, 2024), Indian Wildlife Ecology Conference (IWEC), second international conference on Hangul and other threatened ungulate conservation (2IHUC, 2025), and 8th and 9th World Congress on Mountain Ungulate (WCMU) in Italy and Tajikistan.



Photo by: Tanushree Srivastava & Muneeb Nazir



Glimpses of Wildlife Walkathon and World Species Congress in Hirpora WLS in 2023 and 2024.

Photo by: Tanushree Srivastava



Glimpses of Markhor Day celebration and Wildlife Walkathon in 2023 and 2025.

Photo by: Tanushree Srivastava



To,
Wildlife Warden
North Kashmir Division, Sopore

Ref: WTI/WA/RAP/2023-24/64

Date: 26/03/2024

Sub: Support for human-wildlife conflict mitigation activities in Kashmir Valley

Dear Sir,

I am pleased to inform you that your Rapid Action Project (RAP) equipment request for "Support for human-wildlife conflict mitigation activities in Kashmir Valley" has been approved by our panel. As part of this project 2 motorbikes will be provided to the Forest Department. Please note that all the payment(s) will be directly made to the vendor(s) and the motorbikes will be handed over.

Sameeha Zele and Tanushree Srivastava from WTI will be the point persons for this project, and will coordinate with you further on this matter.

I would request you to kindly take note of the following aspects for this grant-in-aid: -

1. Please send us a signed copy of this letter for our official records.
2. Please share photographs/videos of the activities done while using the equipment in the field.
3. We would appreciate an acknowledgement letter stating how this assistance has been helpful to your team.
4. WTI's support should be acknowledged in any announcements, including print, broadcast and electronic media.

We hope the support provided will assist the forest department in human-wildlife conflict mitigation activities.

Yours Sincerely,

Amrit Menon
Manager & Head,
Wild Aid Division

Wildlife Warden
North Kashmir Division, Sopore

Wildlife Trust of India
F-13, Sector-8, NOIDA - 201301, National Capital Region (NCR) – U.P., India
Tel.: +91 120 4143900 Fax: +91 120 4143933, Email: info@wti.org.in, Website: www.wti.org.in

Wildlife Warden North Division Sopore,
Near Sub-District Hospital Sopore,
Distt, Baramulla, Jammu & Kashmir



Ref: WTI/WA/RAP/2022-23/27

Date: 17/10/2022

Sub: Support to aid with mitigating human-leopard conflicts in Boniyar and Lachipora, Jammu & Kashmir

Dear Sir,

I am pleased to inform you that your request for "Support to aid with mitigating human-leopard conflicts in Boniyar and Lachipora, Jammu & Kashmir" has been sanctioned as a Rapid Action Project. Under this project 4 tents, 5 camera traps, 6 torches and 12 sleeping bags will be provided to the North Division Sopore.

Sameer Khazir & Snehaa S from WTI will be the point persons for this project, and will coordinate with you further on this matter.

I would request you to kindly note the following aspects for this grant-in-aid: -

1. Please share with us a signed copy of this letter for our official records along with a list of beneficiaries receiving the equipment.
2. Request your assistance in sharing good documentation such as photographs/videos of the distribution of the equipment, equipment being used by staff in the field and camera trap footage. This would help in reporting to our donors.
3. We would appreciate an acknowledgment letter stating how this assistance has been helpful with conflict mitigation activities in the landscape.
4. Please acknowledge WTI & Donor support in any announcements, including print, broadcast and electronic media. Please share at least one media article acknowledging WTI's support with the project.

We hope the support provided will motivate the staff and aid in mitigating leopard conflict in Boniyar and Lachipora.

Yours Sincerely,

Snehaa S
Officer In Charge,
Wild Aid Division

Wildlife Warden
North Division Sopore
Jammu & Kashmir
Sopore

Wildlife Trust of India

F-13, Sector-8, NOIDA - 201301, National Capital Region (NCR) – U.P., India
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To,
Wildlife Warden
North Kashmir Division, Sopore

Ref: WTI/WA/RAP/2023-24/64

Date: 26/03/2024

Sub: Support for human-wildlife conflict mitigation activities in Kashmir Valley

Dear Sir,

I am pleased to inform you that your Rapid Action Project (RAP) equipment request for "Support for human-wildlife conflict mitigation activities in Kashmir Valley" has been approved by our panel. As part of this project 2 motorbikes will be provided to the Forest Department. Please note that all the payment(s) will be directly made to the vendor(s) and the motorbikes will be handed over.

Sameeha Zele and Tanushree Srivastava from WTI will be the point persons for this project, and will coordinate with you further on this matter.

I would request you to kindly take note of the following aspects for this grant-in-aid: -

1. Please send us a signed copy of this letter for our official records.
2. Please share photographs/videos of the activities done while using the equipment in the field.
3. We would appreciate an acknowledgement letter stating how this assistance has been helpful to your team.
4. WTI's support should be acknowledged in any announcements, including print, broadcast and electronic media.

We hope the support provided will assist the forest department in human-wildlife conflict mitigation activities.

Yours Sincerely,

Amrit Menon
Manager & Head,
Wild Aid Division

Wildlife Warden
North Kashmir Division, Sopore

Wildlife Trust of India
F-13, Sector-8, NOIDA - 201301, National Capital Region (NCR) – U.P., India
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Wildlife Warden
Chenab Kishtwar Division
Department of Wildlife Protection – J&K Govt.
Forest Complex, Sarkoot - Kishtwar

Ref: WTI/WA/RAP/2026-27/19

Date: 22/09/2026

Sub: Support with a Hero Xpulse 200 4V and field gear to front line staff of the Kishtwar High Altitude National Park - Department of Wildlife Protection – J&K Govt.

Respected Sir,

I am pleased to inform you that your request for a mountain bike & field gear for the front line staff of the Kishtwar High Altitude National Park - Department of Wildlife Protection – J&K Govt. for patrolling and other activities related to protection and conservation of wildlife in the Range, has been sanctioned as a Rapid Action Project. Under this project A Hero Xpulse 200 4V and field gear kit with solar lights (02), Rucksacks (02), Tent (01), Torches (02), Rain gear (02), Puncture Kit (01), Sleeping bags (02) will be provided to the range to strengthen the effectiveness of the staff and to improve their safety.

Habeeba Fathima & Raihanul I Sarkar from WTI will be the point persons for this project, and will coordinate with you further on this matter.

I would request you to kindly take note of the following aspects for this grant-in-aid:

1. Please send us a signed copy of this letter for our official records.
2. Please share good quality photos/videos of the distribution of the items and use in field.
3. Please share data on human-animal conflict, rescues, patrolling operations etc. in the months following the support.
4. We would appreciate an acknowledgment letter stating how this assistance has been helpful.
5. WTI support should be acknowledged in any announcements, including print, broadcast and electronic media.
6. Please share at least one media article acknowledging WTI's support with the project.

We hope the support provided will help your range and the staff.

Yours Sincerely,

Amrit Menon
Head, Wild Aid
Wildlife Trust of India

Mohinder Singh Jamwal
Wildlife Warden – Chenab Division
Kishtwar

Wildlife Trust of India
F-13, Sector-8, NOIDA - 201301, National Capital Region (NCR) – U.P., India
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Photo by: Tanveer Ahmad War & Tanushree Srivastava



Wildlife Trust of India

F-13, Sector - 8,
National Capital Region (NCR)
Noida 201301
India
Ph: +91-120-4143900



Department of Wildlife Protection, J&K

Shiekh Ul Alam Forest Campus,
Silk Factory Road, Rajbagh,
Srinagar - 190008, J&K.



Astral House, Astral Foundation
207/1, Behind Rajpath Club, Off.
SG Highway, Ahmedabad -
380059, Gujarat, India.